# Pembrolizumab 200 mg · every 3 weeks · lung cancer

Pembrolizumab 200 mg is given as a drip over about 30 minutes on Day 1 every 3 weeks (21 days). The hospital visit is longer because of checks and preparation. After complete surgery and platinum chemotherapy, the adjuvant course lasts up to 12 months. For metastatic cancer, treatment continues while it remains helpful and tolerable; the team may consider stopping after 24 months of sustained response without progression, or continuing when appropriate.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

## A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

### 1 Hormones / nervous system

**Pembrolizumab**

Severe headache, confusion, weakness, dizziness or marked thirst need prompt advice.

### 3 Heart

**Pembrolizumab**

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

### 5 Kidneys

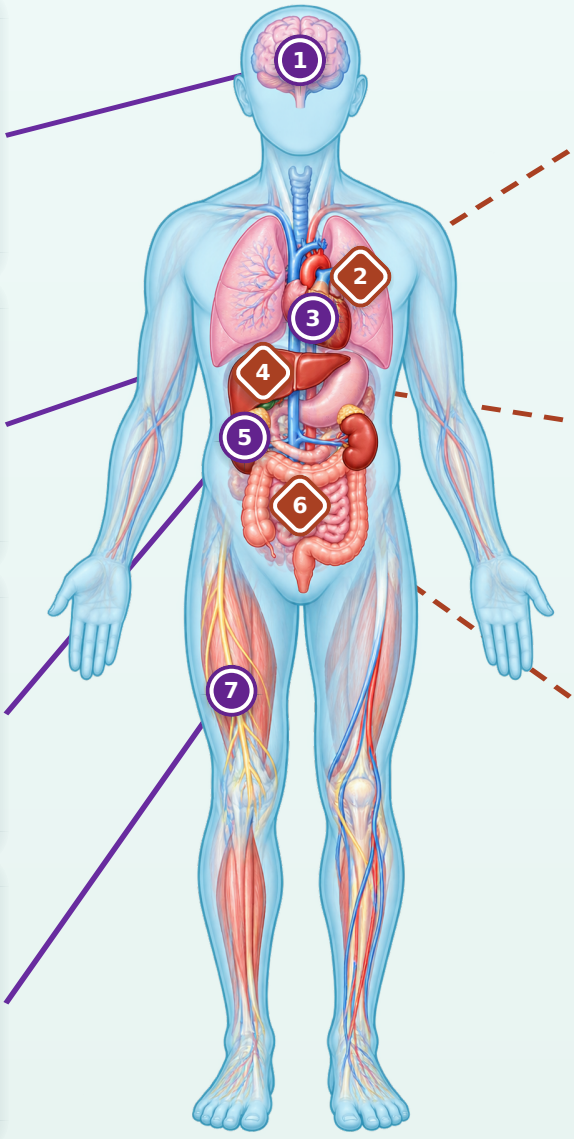
**Pembrolizumab**

Report much less urine, new swelling or a change in kidney tests.

### 7 Skin / muscles

**Pembrolizumab**

Spreading rash, blisters, severe weakness or muscle pain needs prompt review.




### 2 Lungs

**Pembrolizumab**

New cough or breathlessness can signal inflammation or another urgent cause.

### 4 Liver

**Pembrolizumab**

Yellow eyes/skin or dark urine may signal inflammation; tests also check the liver.

### 6 Bowel

**Pembrolizumab**

New or persistent diarrhoea, blood in stools or severe tummy pain needs urgent advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

# Your treatment, at home.

## Important medicine-specific effects

### Pembrolizumab

- Immune inflammation of lungs, bowel, liver, kidneys, hormone glands, skin, heart and nervous system
- Infusion reactions
- Some effects need steroids, hospital care or long-term hormone replacement
- Effects may start after the final dose

**Surgery, radiation and monitoring:** open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

## Make the plan practical

### Sickness medicines

Pembrolizumab alone has a minimal risk of causing sickness. Routine anti-sickness medicines or infusion premedicines are not usually needed; your team can prescribe symptom relief if required.

### Immune alert card

Carry your alert card during treatment and afterwards. Show it when seeking urgent care; symptoms can be mistaken for an infection or an ordinary stomach upset.

### Hormones and steroids

Some immune effects need steroids or hormone replacement. Follow the prescribed plan and do not stop steroids suddenly. Ask for help if symptoms worsen or you cannot take essential medicines.

### Pregnancy and breastfeeding

Discuss pregnancy, fertility and breastfeeding before treatment. Use effective contraception during treatment and for at least four months after the last dose. If pregnancy is possible or occurs, contact your oncology team promptly.

**Emergency: 112 / 999.** Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

**Contact oncology immediately** for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

**Insert numbers here**

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

**Insert numbers here**

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

**Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED**

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

**Complete reference, visual timeline and passport**

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00455/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.